

Malicious Sites



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With Ali Ali

Cybersecurity Awareness Guide for Employees

Malicious Sites

❑ **Malicious websites** are designed to harm your device or steal your personal information. They can appear legitimate, making it challenging to identify them

- **What Are Malicious Sites?**

Malicious websites are created by cybercriminals to:

1. **Install malware**: This includes viruses, spyware, ransomware, and other unwanted software that can damage your device or steal your data
2. **Phish for information**: These sites often mimic legitimate websites to trick you into entering sensitive information like usernames, passwords, or credit card details
3. **Spread disinformation**: Some sites aim to spread false information to cause confusion or influence public opinion

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- **Examples of Malicious Sites:**

1. **Phishing Sites:** These sites look like legitimate ones (e.g., a fake bank website) and ask for your login credentials. *For example*, a site might look like your email provider and prompt you to log in, but your details go straight to the attackers
2. **Malware Sites:** These sites might prompt you to download a file or software that contains malware. *For example*, a site offering free movie downloads might actually install a virus on your device
3. **Fake News Sites:** These sites spread false information to manipulate public opinion or cause panic. *An example* could be a site spreading false information about a health crisis

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How to Protect Your Device

- **How to Protect Your Device**

1. **Use Security Software:** *Install reputable antivirus and anti-malware software. Keep it updated to protect against the latest threats*
2. **Enable Browser Warnings:** *Modern browsers like Chrome and Firefox have built-in features that warn you about unsafe sites. Make sure these are enabled*
3. **Check URLs Carefully:** *Look for misspellings or unusual domain names. Legitimate sites usually use HTTPS (look for the padlock icon in the address bar)*

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How to Protect Your Device

4. ***Avoid Clicking on Suspicious Links:** Be cautious with links in emails, especially if they are from unknown senders or seem out of character for the sender*
5. ***Keep Your Software Updated:** Regular updates for your operating system and applications often include security patches that protect against new threats*
6. ***Educate Yourself:** Stay informed about common cyber threats and how to recognize them. Awareness is a powerful tool in preventing cyber attacks*

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Best practices for using a web browser

1. Use a Secure Browser

*Choose a reputable browser like **Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, or Microsoft Edge**. These browsers have built-in security features and receive regular updates to fix vulnerabilities*

2. Keep Your Browser Updated

*Always update your browser to the latest version. Updates often include security patches that protect against new threats. **For example**, if you're using Chrome, it will automatically update, but you can manually check for updates in the settings*

3. Enable Browser Security Features

*Activate features like pop-up blockers, phishing protection, and safe browsing modes. **For example**, Chrome's Safe Browsing feature warns you about dangerous sites and downloads*

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Best practices for using a web browser

4. Use Strong, Unique Passwords

*Use a password manager to create and store strong, unique passwords for each site. Avoid using the same password across multiple sites. **For example**, tools like LastPass or 1Password can help manage your passwords securely*

5. Be Cautious with Extensions

*Only install extensions from trusted sources and review the permissions they request. **For example**, an ad blocker like uBlock Origin is widely trusted, but always check reviews and permissions before installing*

6. Avoid Clicking on Suspicious Links

*Be wary of links in emails or on websites that seem suspicious. Hover over links to see the actual URL before clicking. **For example**, phishing emails often contain links that look legitimate but lead to malicious sites*

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Best practices for using a web browser

7. Use HTTPS

*Ensure the websites you visit use HTTPS, which encrypts the data exchanged between your browser and the website. Look for the padlock icon in the address bar. **For example**, when shopping online, always check for HTTPS to protect your payment information*

8. Clear Your Cache and Cookies Regularly

*Clearing your browser's cache and cookies can help protect your privacy and improve performance. **For example**, you can clear browsing data in Chrome by going to **Settings > Privacy and Security > Clear Browsing Data***

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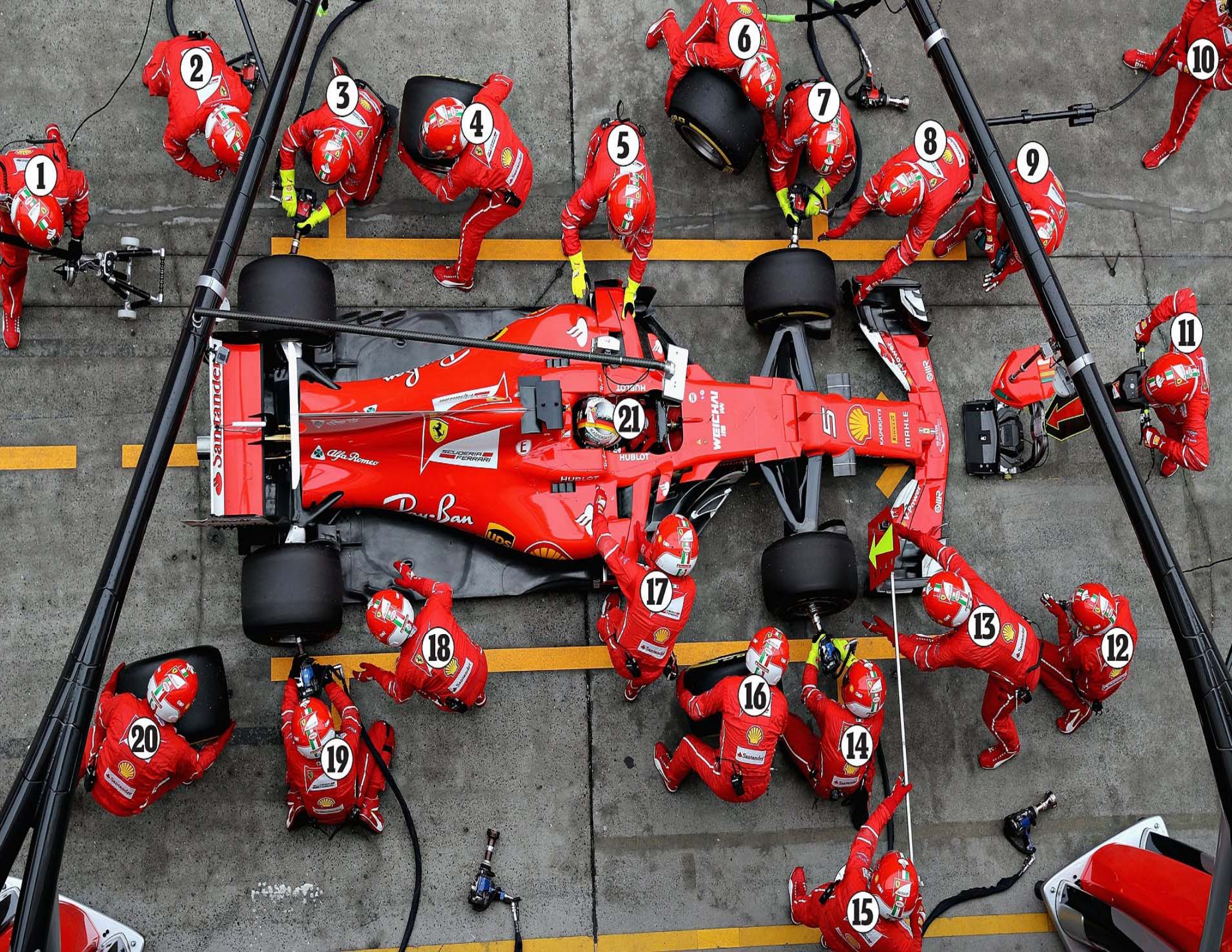
Best practices for using a web browser

9. Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

*Use 2FA for an extra layer of security on your accounts. **For example,** Google and many other services offer 2FA, which requires a second form of verification in addition to your password*

10. Use Private Browsing Mode

*Use private or incognito mode to prevent your browser from saving your browsing history, cookies, and site data. **For example,** use incognito mode in Chrome when accessing sensitive information on a shared computer*



Questions



THANK YOU!

Ali Ali